

Sales guide

Your workflow runs **Lead** → **Deal** → **Quotation** → **Invoice**. Here's how each step works in the CRM.

Your dashboard

When you log in you'll see:

- **Follow-ups due** — leads you need to chase today.
- **Won this month** — value of deals you've closed.
- **Open pipeline by stage** — your live deals and their value.
- **Overdue tasks alert** — if you have tasks past their due date, a red banner

appears with a direct link to your task list.

1. Leads (Lead Generation)

1. Lead Generation → Add Lead.

2. Fill in name, company, phone/email, **source**, the **service** they're interested in, and an **estimated value**. Assign an **owner** (usually you).

1. Save. A **score badge** (0–100) appears on the leads list within a minute — higher means more promising. Hover over it to see the one-line reason (e.g. "Company provided, specific service request, phone available — follow up promptly"). The score updates automatically whenever you edit the lead. The lead page also shows the AI's estimate of their **budget, urgency**, and whether the requested service looks like a good **fit** for them.

Score ≥ 70 is a 🔥 Hot lead — its owner gets an immediate bell notification instead of waiting for the next morning digest, so you can call while the interest is fresh.

Note: leads that existed before AI was enabled show no badge until you open them, make any edit (even adding a note), and save.

Auto-assignment: if a lead comes in with no owner (e.g. from the website form or an unmatched WhatsApp number), the CRM automatically assigns it to whichever active Sales user currently has the fewest open leads — so leads never sit unowned waiting for someone to notice them. This runs whether or not AI is enabled. You'll get the usual "New lead" bell notification as soon as you're assigned.

Campaign source: if a website lead came in through a tracked ad or link, the lead page shows a **Campaign** line (e.g. "google / cpc / seo-pune-2026") so you know which channel it came from before you call.

WhatsApp leads: a WhatsApp message from a number that isn't an existing client's now creates a lead automatically (source = WhatsApp) instead of

being dropped. If the same unknown number messages again before you've converted them, the CRM adds it as a note on the same lead rather than creating a duplicate.

Meta Ads leads: a submission on a Facebook or Instagram lead ad creates a lead automatically (source = Meta Ads). Any question on the ad form beyond name/email/phone/company (e.g. a custom budget question) appears as a note on the lead.

Automatic nurture follow-ups: if a New lead sits with no note or logged call from you for **1, 3, or 7 days**, the CRM drafts a follow-up message for you automatically — it appears as an " ✨ AI-drafted follow-up (touch N/3)" note on the lead, and you get a bell notification. Copy it into WhatsApp or email (editing as needed) and send it yourself — nothing is ever sent automatically. The moment you add your own note or log a call on a lead, the sequence stops (the CRM assumes you've taken it from here).

Working a lead:

- Open the lead to add **notes**, see the timeline, and log activity.
- **Log a call** (top bar or the lead page) after you phone them — record the outcome (connected, no answer, follow-up needed).
- When logging a call, click **Add follow-up reminder** to expand the reminder section. **Set the date and time manually** to the exact day you want to be reminded — the field starts blank so you pick the right date (not just tomorrow). Add a one-line next action (e.g. "Send proposal", "Call back at 3 PM"). The CRM will send you a bell notification when that time arrives, and it appears in your morning digest. Call follow-ups that are overdue show in red on the **Calling** page — use the **Pending follow-ups** button to filter to just those.
- Set a **next follow-up date** on the lead itself so it shows up in your "follow-ups due" dashboard widget.
- **Draft follow-up (✨)** — click this button to have AI write a suggested follow-up message based on the lead's details and history. Read it, edit it to match your voice, then send it yourself (WhatsApp, email, or call). The AI never sends anything automatically.

Converting a lead: when it's real business, open the lead and click

Convert. This creates a **Client** and a **Deal** automatically and links everything together. The new client appears in the **Clients** list with status **Prospect** (shown in yellow) — they become **Active** (green) automatically when you mark their deal as **Won**. Use the status filter on the Clients page to view Prospects, Active, or all clients.

Send Quotation from a lead: you don't have to convert first. Open any lead and click **Send Quotation**. If the lead isn't converted yet, the CRM converts them automatically (creates the Client and Deal), then opens the Quotation

builder with the client and deal already filled in. If they're already a client, it skips conversion and goes straight to the builder. Either way you land on a blank quotation ready to fill in — no manual selection needed.

2. Pipeline (Sales Department)

The **Sales Department** board shows your deals in columns by stage:

New → Contacted → Proposal → Negotiation → Won / Lost.

- **Drag a deal** to the next column as it progresses (or open it and change the stage).

- Won and Lost are final — once set, a deal's **stage** can't change again.

Its **Value** can still be corrected afterwards, though (e.g. if the final amount was entered wrong) — every report, dashboard, and revenue figure picks up the corrected number automatically.

- A **won** deal can become a **Project** for the delivery team.

- On a **Client's** page, the **Deals** tab has Edit/Delete links for every deal, including Won ones — handy for fixing a value or removing a duplicate without leaving the client's profile.

- **Referred by** — if a deal came to NEDS through a partner agency rather than directly, open the deal and set the **Referred by** dropdown to that agency.

Leave it as "Direct (no agency)" for clients who came to NEDS on their own.

This lets management see which deals were agency-sourced vs direct.

- **Value (₹) is required** when adding or editing a deal — enter your best estimate even early on (New/Contacted) and correct it as the deal firms up.

It drives every figure in the KPI strip below, so a missing or 0 value understates your own numbers.

KPI strip — above the board, seven figures scoped to your own deals

(Admin/Manager see the whole company's pipeline instead):

- **Open pipeline** — total value of everything still open (not yet Won/Lost).

- **Weighted forecast** — open pipeline value adjusted by a rough likelihood-to-close per stage (New 10%, Contacted 25%, Proposal 50%, Negotiation 75%) — a more realistic number than raw pipeline value, since not everything in New will actually close.

- **Won this month / Won this FY** — value of deals you've won, this calendar month and this financial year (Apr–Mar) to date.

- **Win rate** — $\text{Won} \div (\text{Won} + \text{Lost})$, all-time.

- **Avg deal size** — average value of your Won deals.

- **Avg sales cycle** — average days from a deal's creation to it being won.

Stage conversion — below the KPI strip, what % of deals that ever reached one stage went on to reach the next (New→Contacted, Contacted→Proposal, Proposal→Negotiation, Negotiation→Won). This is built from deal moves going forward only, so each pair shows "Not enough data yet" until at least 5 deals have passed through it — it doesn't reconstruct history from before this

feature shipped.

Stale-deal badge — each card shows how many days it's been sitting in its current stage, turning red past 10 days. A red badge is a nudge to follow up or move the deal, not an automatic penalty.

2a. Sales Dashboard

A dedicated page (Sidebar → **Sales Dashboard**) for a fuller view than the board's KPI strip — same numbers, scoped the same way (your own deals; Admin/Manager see everyone):

- **Target vs actual** — a progress bar against your monthly (and FY, if set) revenue target, if Admin/Manager has set one for you. "No target set" is normal if they haven't.
- **Won value — last 12 months** — a trend chart, so you can see whether this month is actually better or worse than recent months, not just in isolation.
- **Service-line breakdown** — your pipeline and win rate per service (SEO, Website Dev, etc.), so you can see which services are actually converting.
- **Needs attention** — a plain list of deals that need a look: stale >10 days, an overdue follow-up date, no owner, or a ₹0 value that was never corrected. Each links straight to the deal.

Admin/Manager additionally see a **rep leaderboard** (pipeline, won this month, target %, win rate, avg deal size per Sales rep) and a **Save targets** form to set the company's monthly/FY target and each rep's monthly target.

3. Quotations

1. **Quotations → Create** — or open a **Deal** and click **+ New Quotation** directly on the deal page (the client and deal are pre-filled for you) — or open a **Lead** and click **Send Quotation** (the CRM converts the lead and pre-fills the builder for you automatically).

1. Add **line items** (description, HSN/SAC, quantity, rate). GST is calculated per line (CGST+SGST for Maharashtra clients, IGST otherwise).

1. For milestone/project work, add **milestones** (e.g. advance on signing, balance on delivery). Once work starts, whoever runs the project marks each milestone **Pending / In Progress / Done** on the quotation page — that's how accounts knows a phase is finished and it's time to raise the next invoice.

1. Save, then **download the PDF** to send to the client.
2. When the client agrees, mark the quotation **Accepted**, then ****Convert to invoice**** — accounts takes it from there.

All quotations linked to a deal are listed on the deal's page so you can track which version the client accepted.

4. Clients

Clients lists the companies assigned to you, plus any unassigned ones. Only your clients and unassigned clients appear in your list — clients owned by other sales reps are not shown. Open a client to see its contacts, notes, calls, deals, invoices and tickets in one place.

Adding clients: use **Clients** → **Add** for a single client, or **Clients** → **Import** to upload a CSV file in bulk. Download the template from the Import page — it includes columns for address, owner (type a user's name exactly), and tags (comma-separated, e.g. `seo, retainer`). If you leave the **Owner** column blank, the client is assigned to you automatically. Click **Continue** and wait for "Uploading..." to clear before the step advances — large files take a moment.

Overseas clients (outside India): set the **Country** field to the client's country (e.g. "United States"). This hides the GSTIN and State fields (which don't apply) and tells the system to produce zero-rated invoices for that client — no GST is charged, and the PDF is labelled "Export of Services" automatically. Leave Country as "India" for all domestic clients.

Non-GST clients (domestic): for a domestic client who has arranged to be billed without GST, tick **Non-GST client** on their profile — new quotations and invoices for them default to no GST charged. This is different from Overseas: the client is still in India, NEDS is just not charging GST on their bills. Can still be overridden per document if needed.

Monthly wins note (AI, optional): on the 1st of each month, if AI is enabled and one of your clients had tasks completed, tickets resolved, a payment, or (for clients on Drishti) posts published/audits completed in the month before, Claude drafts a short "here's what we delivered" note and adds it to that client's **Notes** tab (marked "AI-drafted monthly update"). It's staff-only — the client never sees it automatically. Review it, personalize it, and send it yourself via email or WhatsApp if it reads right.

Daily project update drafts (AI, optional): if AI is enabled, every evening at 6:30 PM Claude drafts a short client-facing update for each of your active projects that had a task completed that day (skipped on Sundays, and skipped entirely if nothing was completed). Unlike the monthly wins note, this one has a built-in send step: open the project page and you'll see a ****Pending Client Update**** panel above Notes & Client Updates. Edit the wording if you like, then click **Approve & Send** — this posts it to the client's portal under "Updates from Our Team" *and* emails it to the client's billing contact, in one step. Click **Discard** instead if a day's draft isn't worth sharing. Nothing reaches the client until you approve it.

5. Content pieces (when you're a project's Project Manager)

If you are set as the **Project Manager** of a project, you can track content pieces for that project — useful when NEDS is managing social media or other content for a client alongside a partner agency.

Adding a content piece: open the project → **Content Pieces** card →

Add piece. Choose the workflow type:

- **Agency-led** — the partner agency creates the content and delivers it to NEDS for publishing. Starts in **Pending from agency**.
- **NEDS-led** — NEDS writes the copy/brief first, sends it to the partner for visuals, then publishes. Starts in **Copy drafting**. ****If the copy was written in SMDost and marked "Send to agency" there, the piece is created automatically**** in **Sent to partner** status — no need to add it manually. Fill in the platform (Instagram, Facebook, etc.), title, publish date, and any notes. Assign a partner if one is involved.

Advancing status: open the content piece → click the **Move to...** button to move it to the next step. When a piece is marked **Published**, the timestamp is recorded automatically.

Google Drive: you can store a Drive link on each piece (for the specific file) and on the project itself (for the shared folder). These appear as clickable links so you can jump straight to the asset.

Upload links (generating one requires manager access — ask your manager). Once a link is generated you can copy it and send it to the partner; they upload files without needing a CRM login.

6. Quotations — sending to clients

Once a quotation is ready, open it and click **Send to Client**. This emails the quotation details to the client's billing address and marks it as Sent. The client can then accept or request changes.

Bell notifications

The 🔔 bell icon at the top of the screen shows real-time alerts for your key events. You'll be notified when:

Event	Who gets it
 New lead created	The assigned sales person — or all sales staff if the lead has no owner yet (rare now that leads auto-assign)
 Hot lead (AI score ≥ 70)	The lead's owner, as soon as the score comes back — no need to wait for the morning digest
 Nurture follow-up drafted	The lead's owner, when a New lead has gone 1/3/7 days with no note or call from you
 New quotation created	The deal's assigned sales person
 Deal marked Won	The deal's assigned sales person + all managers and admins
 New invoice created	The client's assigned sales person (recurring auto-invoices are excluded to avoid noise)
 Monthly wins note drafted	The client's assigned sales person, on the 1st of each month for clients with something to report the month before
 Project daily update ready to review	The project owner, at 6:30 PM on days a task was completed on one of their projects

Click any notification to jump straight to the record. Click **Dismiss** to clear it.

Email alerts

The CRM sends you two types of automated emails to help you stay on top of things:

Morning digest (9 AM daily) — a summary of your day: overdue tasks, tasks due today, call follow-ups due, lead follow-ups, deal follow-ups, and open tickets.

No email means your slate is clean. If AI is enabled, it opens with a short AI-written line on what to prioritise — the same line also shows as a banner on your dashboard for the rest of the day.

Stagnation alert (10 AM daily) — if any of your leads haven't had any activity (note, call, or edit) for **7 days**, or any of your deals for **10 days**, you'll get a reminder. Even adding a brief note resets the clock.

Tips

- Use the **search bar** to jump straight to any lead, client or deal.
- Keep **notes** and **call outcomes** up to date — they drive your follow-up list, your performance report, and the stagnation clock.